



Cameras are, dare I say, the fastest-evolving component in smartphones. In 2023, we saw AI take centre stage once again in the camera space with improvements to software image processing from just about every smartphone OEM and chipset manufacturer. With that, we also witnessed some rather monumental strides being made in camera hardware as well. 1-inch sensors became more common to combat low-light inadequacies. Moreover, for manufacturers who didn't want to give up as much real estate to massive sensors – especially in foldable phones – pixel-stacking cameras entered the scene to save the day.

Winner: Apple iPhone 15 Pro

The Apple iPhone 15 Pro has improved by leaps and bounds this year. First, the phone's 48-megapixel Quad-Bayer sensor saves images in 24 MP by default. This translates to enhanced detail retention in pretty much every scenario in daylight – you will see an improvement in clarity. Moreover, the HDR issues that plagued the iPhones have been alleviated. We definitely saw improved dynamic range across the array of lenses on the iPhone 15 Pro. Moreover, colours look true-to-life and are consistent across the board, portraits have a realistic bokeh effect with excellent edge detection, and low-light photography is impressive as well. Video, one of Apple's strongest suits, becomes better with Cinematic Mode now available at 4K at 30 fps, support for LOG encoding,

Camera Phone

Shooting for the stars



Apple iPhone 15 Pro
Price: ₹1,34,900

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



Honor 90 5G
Price: ₹37,999

and much more. The iPhone 15 Pro is truly one of the most reliable smartphone camera systems you can get your hands on.

Runner-up: Vivo X90 Pro

While Apple snagged the win, the Vivo X90 Pro outshone the winner in one area – low-light photography. It sports a 1-inch camera sensor which performs exceedingly well in low-light by clicking excellent images packed with detail. Add to that fantastic daylight shots, and some of the best portrait photography in the business, and the Vivo X90 Pro is a formidable smartphone camera. It only lost out to the iPhone 15 Pro since the latter was able to extract more detail from images and the video recording abilities are far superior.



Vivo X90 Pro
Price: ₹84,999

2nd Runner-up: Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra

The Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra continues to be a top recommendation from us at Digit in the smartphone camera category. It mainly loses out on points because of the noise creeping into its low-light videography and the softness in low-light 3x portrait shots.



Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra
Price: ₹1,24,999

Best Buy: Honor 90 5G

The Honor 90 5G punches above its weight at a fraction of the cost of the flagships in this category. It captures solid pictures in ideal lighting conditions. In terms of HDR performance is not world-class, it hold its own in its price range. The ultrawide camera shows promise with good colour and detail as well. Barrel distortion is also minimal. The portrait images look good for sharing on social media, although colour accuracy could be better. At an affordable price of ₹37,999, the Honor 90 5G offers great bang for your buck, winning it the Best Buy Award.

— Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in